According to Ashfaq, just a month before the Soviet coup, Amin had given about half a dozen interviews, mostly to Western correspondents, about his desire to execute a new Afghan constitution by April 1980 with the approval of the Loyajirgah (tribal parliament) to ensure the establishment of a socialist society. Amin also said the Afghan refugees in Pakistan were a handful of terrorists who had fled the country and were now being assisted by Pakistan and the US, and added that the Soviet Union would support his government if the country were be attacked from Pakistani soil.

Amin was so confident of his longevity as Afghanistan's president that on 3 November 1979, he and the council of Afghan ministers approved agreements with the Soviet Union for the purchase of equipment to drill oil and gas wells as part of the Jarqudug project. Before the project could be inaugurated, President Amin was dead.

An Indian dispatch revealed that the coup had been very carefully planned. Amin's Soviet advisors had persuaded him to shift to Darula-man Palace, where he was effectively isolated. Whatever was left of the Afghan army had been deployed in areas far from Kabul and some units had been disarmed or confined to barracks. The Soviet Union justified this massive military intervention on the grounds of a specific request made by the Afghan leadership under the Soviet Afghan treaty of friendship, good neighbourliness and cooperation signed on 5 December 1978.

The Soviet army took charge of all the important places in Kabul as a sense of calm slowly returned to the city after a period of fear and tension made worse by a brief round of firing on the night of 30 December. However, it was clear that the Afghans